

Course Reflection

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When I started this course, I was really motivated to learn more about teaching methods and the kind of vocabulary that's used in discussions about teaching. Earlier in the summer, I went to a teaching workshop, and I realized how unfamiliar I was with a lot of the terms and ideas being talked about. Up until then, I'd mostly designed my classes based on intuition or by mimicking what I'd experienced as a student. I wanted to explore more and see what else was out there, and this course gave me exactly that foundation.

The readings were especially helpful—they answered some of my big questions but also left me with new ones, which I think is a good thing. They made me think more critically about traditional teaching methods and how they work (or don't). One of my future goals is to keep asking those questions and looking for answers, especially when it comes to improving those traditional approaches.

One experience that really stood out to me was the class observation. I've done observations before, but it was always to give feedback to teaching assistants. Observing a full lecture to focus on teaching strategies was different. It gave me a new perspective on how to approach lesson planning and showed me how much you can learn just by paying attention to the choices an instructor makes. It's something I'll definitely carry forward as I work on improving my own teaching.

- Looking ahead, I see myself continuing to teach math or math-related sciences, and I really enjoy showing students the reasoning behind concepts—it's so rewarding when they finally "get it." I'd also love to work in a research setting that combines math and teaching, so I can keep learning and contributing in both areas.

To keep growing as a teacher, I'm planning to attend more workshops, read up on teaching strategies, and experiment with different methods in my classes. Feedback is also super important, so I'll make sure to keep asking my students and peers for their thoughts. All of this will help me become a better teacher and stay connected to the things I'm passionate about.